

Freshman Alumni Bot

A guide for group leaders · @freshmanalumni_bot · everything below takes about five minutes.

1 Set yourself up (once, before anything else)

- 1 Open a private chat with @freshmanalumni_bot and tap **Start**. The bot replies to you privately, and Telegram won't let it message you until you've done this.
- 2 Send /id in that chat. It replies with your Telegram ID number.
- 3 Send that number to @gapyearingdoesntsuck and ask to be added as a bot admin.

Until step 3 is done, nothing else works.

Every command below checks the admin list first, and for everyone else does **nothing at all** — no error, just silence. That's deliberate: it stops members discovering the commands. Don't read it as the bot being broken.

2 Add the bot to your group

- 1 In your group: **Members** → **Add member** → @freshmanalumni_bot.
 - 2 Promote it to **Administrator** and turn on **Pin messages**. Admin rights are not optional — without them Telegram never tells the bot who joins.
 - 3 Promoting it **is** the switch-on: the bot starts watching the group by itself and DMs you to confirm. There is nothing to configure.
 - 4 Send /gate_announce in the group. The bot posts the join announcement and pins it. You're done.
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3 What the bot puts in your group

Exactly two things ever appear in the group chat:

- 1 **The pinned announcement** — two buttons, *Join the Alumni group* and *I'm already in it*. It re-posts itself every five days and deletes the previous one, so only one is ever live.
- 2 **A follow-up message** naming the people who still haven't tapped either button, sent a few days after the announcement.

Everything else is a private DM. Nobody is tagged in the group for not having joined, and nobody is corrected in front of everyone. Replies to your own commands are DMed to you too, even when you type the command in the group.

4 The commands you'll use

Type these in the group:

- /gate_announce Post and pin the announcement now, without waiting for the five-day cycle.
- /gate_unwatch Stop the bot working in this group. Records are kept.
- /id Get this group's ID number — useful when reporting a problem.

Type these in your private chat with the bot:

- /gate_stats How many people are already in, mid-onboarding, or still unengaged.
 - /gate_groups Every group the bot is currently watching.
 - /gate_list Everyone who has completed registration through the bot.
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5 When something looks wrong

- Commands do nothing** You're not on the admin list yet — go back to section 1.
- No announcement** The bot isn't an admin in the group. Check its rights, then re-run /gate_announce.
- "But I am in it!"** Almost always a second Telegram account. Ask which account they use in the alumni group, and have them message the bot from that one.
- Anything else** Message @gapyearingdoesntsuck.